I travelled to the second Test match in Bangalore determined to play a big innings. However, this time round I was bowled for 17 by a ball from the right-arm fast bowler Doug Bracewell that didn't swing as much as expected and continued going straight. When I went out to bat in the second innings I tried to play myself in, hoping that spending some time at the crease would help. I managed to hit a few fours before getting out for 27 to a Tim Southee delivery that swung back in to knock me over.

It was not the best start to the season, but I put it behind me and focused my attention on the England series that started in November 2012. As part of the preparation I played for Mumbai in a Ranji Trophy game against Railways on 2 November. In my one innings, I had to battle physical exhaustion, as I had had serious food poisoning just before the game and was feeling extremely weak; so much so, in fact, that I asked Rohit Sharma to bat ahead of me. By the time I went in, I had recovered enough to make 137, which was a very satisfying knock considering how I'd felt a few hours earlier. Suddenly I was playing my shots and feeling positive again.

England in India, November–December 2012

I thought I started well against England in the first Test at Ahmedabad on 15 November. My body position and balance were perfect and I was getting into a really good rhythm. From the off, I played some cracking strokes, including a very pleasing lofted shot against Swann over midwicket. I set out to bat aggressively and not hold myself back, because that was how I had scored the Ranji Trophy hundred. Seeing me go over the short midwicket fielder, Swann pushed a man back and I decided to counter him by going over mid on. The ball had drift, however, and instead of playing it over mid on, I hit it straight to the midwicket fielder and I was out for 13. I was very angry with myself for not making the most of my good form.

In the context of the match, my failure in Ahmedabad did not matter in the end, with Sehwag making 117 and Cheteshwar Pujara going on to score an excellent double century. He paced his innings beautifully and has the temperament and the patience to be a top-class Test batsman in the years to come. He has all the shots and is a much-improved player since his debut against Australia in 2010. Pragyan Ojha and Ravi Ashwin then got in on the act and ran through England in both innings.